

Simtora Technologies UK Limited

United Kingdom HR Manual (London)

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Applies to	All employees of Simtora Technologies UK Limited ("Simtora UK" or "the Company") working in London or elsewhere in England and Wales. Employees in Scotland or Northern Ireland are covered by this manual as far as the law allows, with local variations noted by HR
Related manuals	Global People Supplement (SIM-HR-002); HR Policy Manual (SIM-HR-001); International Operations Supplement (SIM-GLB-001); IT Policy Manual (SIM-IT-001); Finance and Accounting Manual (SIM-FIN-001); Procurement Policy Manual (SIM-PRC-001); Code of Ethics and Compliance Manual (SIM-CMP-001); Facilities and Office Administration Manual (SIM-FAC-001)

Contents

Introduction

Part 1 – Employer, Legal Framework and Scope

- 1.1 Employer and Scope
- 1.2 Legal Framework
- 1.3 How the HR Policy Manual Applies in the UK
- 1.4 Local Authorities and Contacts

Part 2 – Hiring, Contracts and Probation

- 2.1 Recruitment, Right to Work and Background Checks
- 2.2 Written Statement of Particulars and Employment Categories
- 2.3 Probation
- 2.4 Onboarding

Part 3 – Working Time, Remote Work and On-Call

- 3.1 Working Hours and Rest
- 3.2 Overtime and Time Off in Lieu
- 3.3 Flexible Working and Hybrid Work
- 3.4 Right to Disconnect
- 3.5 On-Call and Follow-the-Sun

Part 4 – Pay, Payroll, Tax and Pensions

- 4.1 Salary and Payment
- 4.2 Deductions
- 4.3 PAYE, National Insurance and Reporting
- 4.4 Bonuses, Allowances and Equity
- 4.5 Expenses and Business Travel

Part 5 – Leave and Holidays

- 5.1 Bank Holidays

- 5.2 Annual Leave
- 5.3 Sickness Absence and Sick Pay
- 5.4 Maternity, Paternity, Adoption, Shared Parental and Related Leave
- 5.5 Time Off for Dependants, Carers and Other Leave
- 5.6 Bereavement and Parental Bereavement

Part 6 – Benefits and Pensions

- 6.1 Workplace Pension
- 6.2 Health, Life and Income Protection
- 6.3 Other Benefits

Part 7 – Equality, Respect, Employee Voice and Speaking Up

- 7.1 Equality and Diversity
- 7.2 Harassment, Bullying and the Duty to Prevent
- 7.3 Grievances
- 7.4 Employee Representation and Consultation
- 7.5 Whistleblowing

Part 8 – Safety, Privacy and Intellectual Property

- 8.1 Health and Safety
- 8.2 Data Protection, Monitoring and Records
- 8.3 Confidentiality, IP and Restrictive Covenants

Part 9 – Performance, Discipline and Separation

- 9.1 Performance and Capability
- 9.2 Disciplinary Procedure
- 9.3 Resignation
- 9.4 Termination by the Company and Redundancy
- 9.5 Final Pay and Offboarding

Part 10 – Local Practices

- 10.1 Working with London and U.S. Teams
- 10.2 Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland

- 10.3 London Specifics

Appendices

- A. Key Terms Summary and Acknowledgement
 - B. Bank Holiday Calendar Rules
 - C. Statutory Deadlines
 - D. Revision History
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Introduction

This manual sets the employment terms for people who work for **Simtora Technologies UK Limited**, the UK subsidiary of Simtora Technologies, Inc., in the **London R&D Center**. London has about 18 employees and leads evaluation, safety testing and red-teaming for Simtora Assist, platform engineering and EMEA customer engineering.

It sits within the framework of the Global People Supplement (SIM-HR-002) and replaces the U.S.-only parts of the HR Policy Manual (SIM-HR-001) for UK employees. UK employment law is set by statute and case law; contracts cannot reduce statutory rights.

Note on reform. The Employment Rights Act 2025 introduces many changes in stages from 2026 to 2027 (for example, rights from day one for statutory sick pay, paternity and parental leave, a shorter qualifying period for unfair dismissal, and tighter rules on dismissals and harassment). Where this manual states a rule that is scheduled to change, it says so. HR updates the manual within 30 days of each change taking effect. **If the law gives the employee more than this manual, the law applies.**

Principles

1. We comply with UK law and the ACAS Codes of Practice, and we go beyond the minimum where we can.
 2. We apply a fair procedure to every discipline, dismissal and redundancy, **from the first day** of employment.
 3. We take steps to prevent harassment, not just respond to it.
 4. We respect rest, leave and the right to disconnect.
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Part 1 – Employer, Legal Framework and Scope

1.1 Employer and Scope

- The employer is **Simtora Technologies UK Limited**, a private company limited by shares registered at Companies House in England and Wales, with its registered office in London. The **Director of the London R&D Center** leads the site.
- The manual applies to all employees, apprentices and interns who are employees or workers. Contractors and consultants are covered only by their contracts. HR and Legal assess employment status and, where relevant, **off-payroll working (IR35)** before engagement (SIM-PRC-001 6.3).
- HR support: the International HR Lead and the London HR partner (`hr-intl@simtora.example`), with an external payroll provider and UK employment counsel.

1.2 Legal Framework

Area	Main law
Employment rights	Employment Rights Act 1996; Employment Rights Act 2025 (phased)
Working time	Working Time Regulations 1998
Pay	National Minimum Wage Act 1998; Income Tax (Earnings and Pensions) Act 2003; Social Security Contributions and Benefits Act 1992 (statutory pay)
Pensions	Pensions Act 2008 (automatic enrolment)
Family leave	Maternity and Parental Leave etc. Regulations 1999; Paternity and Adoption Leave Regulations 2002; Shared Parental Leave Regulations 2014; Neonatal Care (Leave and Pay) Act 2023; Carer's Leave Act 2023

1.3 How the HR Policy Manual Applies in the UK

See SIM-HR-002 Section 1.2. In short:

- **Not applicable:** at-will employment, FLSA, PTO, sick and safe leave, FMLA, 401(k), COBRA, paid holidays, resignation, termination, job abandonment and final pay (SIM-HR-001 1.2, 6.1–6.4, 6.9, 9.1–9.4). This manual replaces them.
- **Apply with changes in this manual:** onboarding, probation, pay, expenses, monitoring, attendance, corrective action, PIPs, accommodation, safety, hours, flexible and hybrid work, on-call, parental leave, equipment, travel.
- **Apply as written:** conduct, performance, grievances, anti-harassment standards, speaking up, dress code, relationships, bereavement, learning, mobility, recognition.

1.4 Local Authorities and Contacts

Subject	Body
Employment advice and conciliation	ACAS
Employment tribunals	Employment Tribunal (England and Wales); early conciliation through ACAS first
Enforcement of pay, holiday pay and sick pay	Fair Work Agency (from its start), HMRC for national minimum wage
Tax and National Insurance	HMRC
Pensions	The Pensions Regulator
Health and safety	Health and Safety Executive (HSE); local authority; London Fire Brigade
Data protection	Information Commissioner's Office (ICO)
Immigration	Home Office (UK Visas and Immigration)
Equality	Equality and Human Rights Commission

Part 2 – Hiring, Contracts and Probation

2.1 Recruitment, Right to Work and Background Checks

- Vacancies are posted with the **salary range** (SIM-HR-002 1.7). Simtora does not ask candidates about salary history.
- Selection is on merit and free from discrimination under the Equality Act. Health questions are not asked before a job offer except as the Act permits (for example, adjustments, and ability to perform essential duties).
- **Right to work.** Before the first day, HR checks and records every new hire's right to work in the UK (using the Home Office online service, an identity-document service provider for British and Irish passport holders, or manual document checks as the law provides). Follow-up checks are made for time-limited permissions. Employing someone without the right to work carries heavy civil and criminal penalties.
- **Visa sponsorship.** The Company holds a sponsor licence for skilled-worker roles approved in advance; HR starts the process at least 90 days before the intended start (SIM-HR-002 1.10).
- Background checks (identity, qualifications, references) need consent. Criminal-record checks only where the role is legally eligible, and with the correct level of check.
- Applicant data is deleted **6 months** after the process ends unless the candidate agrees to a longer period.

2.2 Written Statement of Particulars and Employment Categories

- Every employee and worker receives a **written statement of employment particulars** (employment contract) **on or before the first day**, including: names, start date, job title and description, place of work, pay and pay days, hours and days, annual leave and holiday pay, sick pay, other leave, other benefits, notice, probation, training and any collective agreements. The statement is updated within one month of any change.

- **Permanent** employment is the default. **Fixed-term** contracts are used for defined projects or cover, are renewed rarely, and have the same rights as permanent staff pro rata. **Part-time** employees are treated no less favorably than full-time colleagues.
- **Interns and apprentices** follow National Minimum Wage rules; HR approves each.
- **Agency workers** are used only through approved agencies and have equal treatment on pay and conditions after 12 weeks.
- **Zero-hours contracts** are not used.

2.3 Probation

- Probation is **3 months** from the start date. It may be **extended once, to a maximum of 6 months** in total, by written notice before the end of the period that states the reasons and goals.
- **Notice during probation: 1 week** from either party (the statutory minimum after one month's service).
- Reviews (SIM-HR-001 Appendix C) take place at 6 weeks and 10 weeks. HR confirms the outcome in writing before the end of the period.
- Probation does not reduce statutory rights. A person on probation has the full benefit of the Equality Act, whistleblowing protection and family-related protections from day one. Simtora applies the disciplinary and dismissal procedures in Part 9 in probation too (in a shortened form).

2.4 Onboarding

Follow SIM-HR-001 1.3 and SIM-HR-002 Appendix C with these local steps: right-to-work check (before the first day); written statement; P45 or Starter Checklist for HMRC; National Insurance number; bank details; automatic enrolment into the workplace pension (6.1); health and safety induction and workstation assessment (8.1); privacy notice and monitoring notice (8.2); equal opportunities and harassment training. Mandatory training (security, privacy, code of conduct, anti-harassment) within **30 days**.

Part 3 – Working Time, Remote Work and On-Call

3.1 Working Hours and Rest

Item	Rule
Standard week	Monday to Friday, 8 hours a day plus a 1-hour unpaid lunch, 40 hours a week
Core hours	10:00 a.m. to 3:00 p.m. London time (GMT / BST)
Weekly maximum	48 hours a week on average over 17 weeks. Employees may agree in writing to opt out; the Company never requires anyone to opt out, and an employee may cancel an opt-out on 7 days' notice.
Rest break	At least 20 minutes if the working day is more than 6 hours
Daily rest	At least 11 hours between working days
Weekly rest	At least 24 hours uninterrupted each week (or 48 hours each fortnight)
Night work	Night workers (those who regularly work at least 3 hours between 11 p.m. and 6 a.m.) average no more than 8 hours in 24, and are offered free health assessments

Employees with unmeasured working time (senior roles) are still covered by the rest and leave rules.

3.2 Overtime and Time Off in Lieu

- Salaried employees are not paid overtime unless the contract says so. Pay must always meet the **National Minimum Wage / National Living Wage** when calculated over all hours worked.

- Extra hours require manager approval in advance, except in an incident. The Company offers **time off in lieu (TOIL)** for significant extra hours, taken within 3 months at a time agreed with the manager.

3.3 Flexible Working and Hybrid Work

- **Hybrid by default:** anchor days **Tuesday to Thursday**, minimum 3 office days a week (SIM-HR-001 5.2).
- **Statutory right to request flexible working** from the first day of employment: up to two requests in any 12 months. The Company **decides within 1 month** (the law allows 2 months), after consulting the employee, and may refuse only on a statutory ground, giving the reasons in writing. An employee can appeal.
- Fully remote roles are within the UK; work outside the UK needs approval (SIM-HR-002 1.9).
- The Company provides equipment, a one-time home-office allowance (GBP equivalent of US 500 *or* 1,000) and a connectivity stipend (GBP equivalent of US \$75 a month), paid with the tax treatment HMRC allows. Employees working at home complete a DSE self-assessment (8.1).

3.4 Right to Disconnect

There is no general statutory right to disconnect in the UK, but the Company applies the global standard (SIM-HR-002 1.4): employees are not expected to read or respond to work messages outside working hours except when on call or in a declared incident. Managers do not penalize employees for not responding and set the example. Meetings are scheduled within 9:00 a.m. to 6:30 p.m. London time, with fair rotation of exceptions (SIM-HR-002 1.6).

3.5 On-Call and Follow-the-Sun

- London takes part in the follow-the-sun rota in the UK and European daytime and evening. Regular on-call falls between **7:00 a.m. and 10:00 p.m.**; overnight on-call is backup only for Severity 1 events (SIM-HR-002 1.6).

- On-call is by rotation, not more than **one week in four** without consent, with at least 2 weeks' notice.
 - **On-call allowance:** a GBP allowance for each rotation week, published on the intranet. On-call time at home is generally not working time unless the restrictions are so tight that the employee cannot pursue personal activities. **Time at the workplace or time actually working is working time.**
 - **Call-outs:** paid as normal working time (or TOIL by agreement) with a **minimum of 2 hours' pay** per call-out. Call-out time counts toward the 48-hour average and rest rules. If a call-out interrupts the 11-hour rest, the employee takes **compensatory rest** (a later start, with no loss of pay).
 - Employees may ask to leave the rota for health or caring reasons; HR considers adjustments (7.1).
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Part 4 – Pay, Payroll, Tax and Pensions

4.1 Salary and Payment

- Salaries are in **pounds sterling (GBP)**, always at or above the National Minimum Wage / National Living Wage that applies to the employee's age.
- Pay is **monthly** by bank transfer, on the **last working day of the month**. An **itemised payslip** is issued on or before pay day (the law requires it to show variable deductions and, where pay varies, hours).
- The annual merit cycle takes effect on April 1.
- Errors are corrected in the next pay run, or by an off-cycle payment within 3 business days if over GBP 500.

4.2 Deductions

Only deductions required by law (tax, National Insurance, student loan, court orders), permitted by the contract, or agreed in writing in advance (for example, a season-ticket loan) are made (Employment Rights Act s 13). **No deductions for loss or damage of**

Company property, errors or cash shortages. Overpayments are recovered only by agreement or as the law allows, in reasonable instalments.

4.3 PAYE, National Insurance and Reporting

Item	Rule
PAYE	Income tax withheld each month and reported to HMRC in real time (RTI) on or before pay day
National Insurance	Employee Class 1 and employer secondary contributions paid monthly; the employment allowance does not apply to the Company if it is not eligible (Finance confirms)
Student loan and other	As HMRC instructs
Year-end	P60 by May 31; P11D (benefits) by July 6; P45 at leaving
Salary sacrifice	Optional for pension, cycle-to-work and similar; the employee is told in writing the effect on pay, benefits and statutory pay

4.4 Bonuses, Allowances and Equity

Item	Rule
Annual performance bonus	By plan document; discretion is exercised rationally and in good faith
On-call allowance	3.5
Home-office allowance and stipend	3.3
Learning budget	GBP equivalent of US \$1,500 a year and 40 hours of paid learning time
Equity	Awards under the Equity Incentive Plan only after Legal and Tax confirm the UK tax and securities treatment, including whether a tax-advantaged option scheme is available (SIM-HR-002 1.7)
Season-ticket loan	Interest-free loan for annual travel passes
Cycle to Work	Through salary sacrifice

4.5 Expenses and Business Travel

- Claims follow SIM-HR-001 1.6 and SIM-FIN-001 4.7, in GBP, within 30 days, paid within 10 business days, with VAT receipts where recoverable.
- Business travel follows SIM-HR-001 8.1 and SIM-HR-002 1.8. Rail is preferred within the UK and to Paris, Brussels and Amsterdam. Flights over 6 hours: economy or premium economy.
- Travel during working hours is working time.

Part 5 – Leave and Holidays

5.1 Bank Holidays

- Simtora UK gives all **8 bank holidays** in England and Wales: New Year's Day, Good Friday, Easter Monday, Early May bank holiday, Spring bank holiday, Summer bank holiday, Christmas Day and Boxing Day. If a holiday falls on a weekend, the next working day is taken. Additional one-off bank holidays proclaimed by the Government are also given.
- Bank holidays are in addition to annual leave (5.2).
- **Floating observance.** Employees may take **2 days a year** of paid leave for religious or cultural days not on the calendar (for example, Eid, Diwali, Yom Kippur, Vaisakhi), with manager approval.

5.2 Annual Leave

Item	Rule
Entitlement	25 days a year plus 8 bank holidays, rising by 1 day a year after 2 years' service to 28 days after 5 years. (Statutory minimum: 5.6 weeks, or 28 days for a 5-day week including bank holidays.) Part-time pro rata.
Holiday year	January 1 to December 31
Accrual	Accrues from the first day; employees may take leave as it accrues
Request	In the HR system, with notice of at least twice the length of leave requested; decisions within 3 business days
Required leave	The Company may require leave on specified dates (for example, a quiet period) with notice of at least twice the length
Carry-over	Up to 5 days may be carried forward to March 31; the statutory minimum carries over if an employee could not take it because of sickness, family leave or because the Company prevented it
Holiday pay	Normal pay including regular overtime, commission and bonuses that are part of normal remuneration (calculated on a 52-week average)
Leave while sick	Leave continues to accrue during sickness and family leave
On leaving	

5.3 Sickness Absence and Sick Pay

Item	Rule
Notice	Tell the manager as early as possible and no later than the start of the working day
Evidence	Self-certify for up to 7 calendar days ; a fit note from a GP or other health professional is needed from the 8th day . The fit note may say the employee "may be fit for work" with adjustments, which the Company considers seriously.
Company sick pay	Full pay for up to 20 working days in any rolling 12 months , from the first day of employment (no waiting days)
Statutory sick pay (SSP)	Paid by law for up to 28 weeks at the rate set each April. From April 2026 SSP is payable from the first day of sickness and without a lower earnings limit at the rate the law sets; Company sick pay is offset against SSP.
Long-term sickness	After the Company sick pay is used, SSP applies, and the group income protection plan (6.2) provides benefit after the plan's deferral period
Return-to-work	A brief return-to-work conversation; adjustments where needed; occupational health referral for repeated or long absences with the employee's consent; fair management of absence under 9.1
Disability	Long-term health conditions may be a disability under the Equality Act. The Company makes reasonable adjustments (7.1) and does not treat disability-related absence as ordinary absence
Medical privacy	The Company sees only fit notes and information needed for its decisions

5.4 Maternity, Paternity, Adoption, Shared Parental and Related Leave

Statutory entitlements

Entitlement	Rule
Maternity leave	Up to 52 weeks (26 ordinary + 26 additional) for every employee from day one, starting as early as 11 weeks before the expected week of childbirth; at least 2 weeks' compulsory leave after birth. Notice by the end of the 15th week before the expected week of childbirth. Statutory Maternity Pay (SMP) for up to 39 weeks : 6 weeks at 90% of average weekly earnings, then 33 weeks at the lower of the statutory flat rate and 90% of earnings (qualifying earnings and service conditions apply).
Paternity leave	1 or 2 weeks for the partner of a birth parent or adopter, within 52 weeks of birth; statutory pay at the flat rate or 90% of earnings if lower. From April 2026 it is a day-one right with no minimum service.
Shared Parental Leave (SPL)	Parents may share up to 50 weeks of leave and 37 weeks of pay
Adoption leave and pay	Up to 52 weeks and 39 weeks of Statutory Adoption Pay
Neonatal care leave	Up to 12 weeks of additional leave and pay for parents whose baby has a neonatal care stay of 7 days or more
Unpaid parental leave	18 weeks per child up to the child's 18th birthday, at most 4 weeks a year, with notice of 21 days; from April 2026 a day-one right
Antenatal care	Paid time off for appointments (and unpaid time off, up to 2 appointments of 6.5 hours, for a partner)
Protection	No detriment or dismissal because of pregnancy or family leave; priority for redeployment in a redundancy during pregnancy and for 18 months after birth; right to return to the same job (or a suitable alternative after additional leave); keeping-in-touch days (up to 10)

Simtora parental leave (SIM-HR-002 1.5)

Caregiver	Simtora benefit
Primary caregiver	Up to 12 weeks at 100% of regular pay , with SMP, SAP or SPLP counted toward the pay; after the 12 weeks, statutory pay continues up to 39 weeks; leave may extend to 52 weeks
Secondary caregiver	Up to 6 weeks at 100% of regular pay , which includes the statutory paternity leave (1 or 2 weeks) and may be taken as a block or two blocks, or as Shared Parental Leave

Eligibility for the Company-funded top-up: **6 months of service** at the date of birth or placement (statutory rights apply from the date the law gives them). The Company-funded leave is taken within 12 months of birth or placement.

5.5 Time Off for Dependants, Carers and Other Leave

Leave	Rule
Time off for dependants	A reasonable amount of time off to deal with an emergency involving a dependant. Simtora pays up to 5 days a year (statutory right is to unpaid time; paid leave is a Company benefit)
Carer's leave	1 week of unpaid leave per year for an employee caring for someone with a long-term care need; a day-one right
Jury service	Regular pay for up to 10 working days a year (the employee claims court allowances, which are taken into account)
Public duties	Reasonable time off for magistrates, councillors and similar duties
Reservists	Leave for training and mobilization as the law provides
Volunteer time	2 paid days a year
Study and exam leave	Up to 5 paid days a year for approved exams
Unpaid personal leave	Up to 90 days with 12 months' service (SIM-HR-001 6.8)
Time off to look for work	In a redundancy, reasonable paid time (9.4)

5.6 Bereavement and Parental Bereavement

- **Bereavement:** 5 paid days (spouse, partner, child, parent, sibling, grandparent, grandchild or household member); 3 paid days for others (SIM-HR-001 6.6).
- **Parental bereavement leave (Jack's Law):** 2 weeks' leave, taken within 56 weeks, for an employee whose child under 18 dies or who suffers a stillbirth after 24 weeks, with statutory parental bereavement pay for eligible employees; the Company pays full pay for the 2 weeks.
- **Miscarriage before 24 weeks:** up to 5 paid days' compassionate leave, in addition to sick leave if needed.
- Additional time can be taken as annual leave or unpaid.

Part 6 – Benefits and Pensions

6.1 Workplace Pension

- Every eligible employee is **automatically enrolled** into the Company workplace pension (a master trust) in line with the Pensions Act 2008. Simtora enrolls **all employees from the first day**, whatever their age or earnings.
- Contributions: the Company pays **6% of basic salary** and the employee pays **at least 4% of basic salary** (more than the statutory minimum, which is a total of 8% of qualifying earnings with at least 3% from the employer). Employees may contribute more through salary sacrifice, with a Company contribution unchanged.
- Employees may opt out within one month of enrollment (to receive a refund) or at any time. Re-enrollment every 3 years as the law requires.
- The Company provides a clear statement of pension benefits and an annual statement.

6.2 Health, Life and Income Protection

Benefit	Detail
Private medical insurance	Company-paid cover for the employee; family cover at employee cost (taxable benefit)
Dental and optical	Cash plan, Company-paid for the employee
Life assurance	Death-in-service benefit of 4 times basic salary , Company-paid
Group income protection	Up to 75% of salary after a 26-week deferral period, Company-paid
Employee Assistance Program	24/7 confidential counseling and legal/financial advice
Eye tests	Eye tests for display screen equipment (DSE) users on request, and a contribution to basic glasses if prescribed for DSE work (8.1)

6.3 Other Benefits

- Season-ticket loan; Cycle to Work; the Company's learning budget; wellness stipend; lunch on anchor days; recognition (SIM-HR-001 7.3, in GBP).
- Annual all-hands in San Francisco for selected representatives, and team gatherings in London.

Part 7 – Equality, Respect, Employee Voice and Speaking Up

7.1 Equality and Diversity

- The Equality Act 2010 protects against discrimination, harassment and victimization because of **age, disability, gender reassignment, marriage and civil partnership,**

pregnancy and maternity, race, religion or belief, sex and sexual orientation.

Simtora's standards (SIM-HR-002 1.4) go further, covering caring status, social background and other grounds.

- **Reasonable adjustments.** The Company must make reasonable adjustments to remove disadvantages for disabled employees and candidates (for example, equipment, flexible hours, changed duties). Employees may ask HR at any time. The Company considers adjustments for long-term health conditions, neurodiversity and menopause symptoms.
- **Equal pay** for equal work; the Company's annual pay-equity analysis covers London. (Gender pay gap reporting applies to employers with 250 or more employees; the Company reports voluntarily to the Executive Team.)
- **Pregnancy and maternity:** special protection (5.4); risk assessments for pregnant and breastfeeding employees.
- **Religion:** reasonable accommodation of prayer, dress and festival needs; a quiet room is available.

7.2 Harassment, Bullying and the Duty to Prevent

- **The preventative duty.** The Company must take **reasonable steps to prevent sexual harassment** of employees in the course of their employment (Equality Act, s 40A, from October 2024). The Employment Rights Act 2025 raises this to "all reasonable steps" and extends protection to harassment by third parties (customers, suppliers, contractors) when those provisions commence. Simtora already meets the higher standard through: a risk assessment, policy, annual training for everyone and extra training for managers, easy and confidential reporting, protection from victimization, prompt investigation, and monitoring of outcomes.
- **Harassment** means unwanted conduct related to a protected characteristic, or of a sexual nature, that violates dignity or creates an intimidating, hostile, degrading, humiliating or offensive environment. **Bullying** is offensive, intimidating or abusive behavior. Both are prohibited (SIM-HR-001 3.2).
- **Procedure.** Report to the manager, London HR partner, Ethics Line (ethics@simtora.example) or the Audit Committee. The Company acknowledges within **2 business days**, investigates promptly, protects the complainant, and informs both parties of the outcome. Informal resolution or mediation is available when appropriate. Compliance is informed of every case (SIM-CMP-001 2.4).

- The Company does not use **non-disclosure agreements** to prevent employees from reporting harassment or discrimination, or from speaking to the police, regulators, lawyers, medical professionals or support services.

7.3 Grievances

- Raise it informally with the manager or HR; if unresolved, submit a **written grievance** to HR.
- HR acknowledges within **3 business days**, invites the employee to a **meeting within 10 working days**, and decides in writing, with the right of appeal, normally within **5 working days** of the meeting. The employee may be **accompanied** by a colleague or trade union representative at the meeting and at any appeal.
- The process follows the **ACAS Code of Practice**. Unreasonable failure by either side to follow it may lead a tribunal to increase or decrease an award by up to 25%.

7.4 Employee Representation and Consultation

- Employees may join a trade union (or not). The Company will not discriminate against or disadvantage anyone for union membership or activity. A union can apply for statutory recognition where the thresholds (21 workers and sufficient support) are met; the Company would follow the statutory process.
- **Information and consultation.** The statutory information and consultation regime applies to undertakings with 50 or more employees, which the Company has not reached; if it does, and employees make a valid request, the Company will negotiate an agreement. Until then, the Director holds an employee forum at least twice a year.
- **Right to be accompanied** at disciplinary and grievance hearings.
- **Collective consultation on redundancy** applies where 20 or more redundancies are proposed at one establishment within 90 days (9.4).
- **TUPE.** If a business transfer takes place, employees' terms transfer with them and information and consultation duties apply (HR and Legal manage).

7.5 Whistleblowing

- A worker who makes a **protected disclosure** — a disclosure in the public interest that they reasonably believe shows a crime, breach of legal duty, miscarriage of justice, danger to health and safety, damage to the environment, or the deliberate concealing of any of these — is protected against dismissal and detriment from the first day of employment.
 - Disclosures can be made to the Company (the manager, HR, the Ethics Line at `ethics@simtora.example` with anonymous reports accepted, or the Audit Committee at `audit@simtora.example`), to a **prescribed person** (such as the FCA, HMRC, the HSE or the ICO), or in limited cases more widely. The Company acknowledges within **5 business days** and protects the whistleblower's identity as far as possible.
 - Dismissal for a protected disclosure is **automatically unfair**; there is no cap on compensation.
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Part 8 – Safety, Privacy and Intellectual Property

8.1 Health and Safety

- The Company has a general duty to ensure, so far as reasonably practicable, the health, safety and welfare of employees and others, including employees working from home.
- **Risk assessments** are made for the office, workstations, lone working, new and expectant mothers, and work-related stress. The Company records its significant findings.
- **Display Screen Equipment.** Employees using screens for a significant part of the day complete a **workstation assessment** at set-up and when things change, including at home; they are offered an **eye test** on request (6.2).
- **Fire safety.** A fire risk assessment, fire wardens, drills and escape routes (SIM-FAC-001). The Company is the "responsible person" under the Fire Safety Order.
- **First aid.** A needs assessment and at least 2 trained first aiders on site.

- **Accident reporting.** Employees report injuries the same day. The Company reports fatal and specified injuries, dangerous occurrences and over-7-day incapacity to the HSE under **RIDDOR** (immediately for the most serious; within 15 days for over-7-day injuries).
- **Employers' liability insurance** of at least GBP 5 million is held and the certificate is available.
- **Emergency numbers: 999** (or 112) and the site security line.
- Employees may stop unsafe work and are protected from detriment when they do so in good faith.

8.2 Data Protection, Monitoring and Records

- **UK GDPR** and the **Data Protection Act 2018** apply. The Company pays the ICO data protection fee. The lawful bases for employee data are generally the contract, legal obligations and legitimate interests. Employees receive a privacy notice at onboarding. Transfers to the U.S. rely on the UK Addendum to the EU standard contractual clauses (or the International Data Transfer Agreement) and, where available, the **UK–U.S. data bridge**.
- **DPO.** The Group Data Protection Officer is the Privacy Lead (`privacy@simtora.example`). Employees may make a **subject access request**; the Company responds within **one month** (extendable by up to two months for complex requests).
- **Monitoring** (SIM-IT-001 4.8) follows the ICO's guidance for monitoring workers: it is **necessary and proportionate**, based on a **data protection impact assessment**, and employees are told clearly what is monitored, why, and for how long. **Covert monitoring** is used only in exceptional cases to investigate suspected serious wrongdoing, with approval from Legal and HR and a documented decision.
- **Records.** Personnel records for **6 years** after employment ends; payroll records for 6 years after the tax year end; right-to-work documents for the employment and 2 years after; working-time records for 2 years; accident records for at least 3 years; maternity records for 3 years after the end of the tax year; applicant data 6 months.

8.3 Confidentiality, IP and Restrictive Covenants

- **Confidentiality** applies during and after employment (SIM-HR-001 1.8).

- **IP.** Copyright in works made by an employee in the course of employment belongs to the employer by law (Copyright, Designs and Patents Act 1988). **Inventions** made in the course of normal duties, or duties specially assigned, belong to the employer (Patents Act 1977, s 39), subject to the employee's right to **fair compensation** if the patent is of outstanding benefit (s 40). The employee's contract assigns all IP to Simtora Technologies, Inc. (via the Company) and includes a waiver of moral rights to the extent the law allows and a duty to disclose inventions.
 - **Restrictive covenants.** A post-employment restriction is enforceable only if it protects a legitimate business interest and goes no further than reasonably necessary. Simtora uses a **non-compete of up to 6 months** (reduced by any garden leave) only for senior or sensitive roles, and **non-solicitation of customers and employees for up to 12 months**, with Legal approval. The Government has proposed capping non-competes at 3 months; Legal monitors this.
 - **Protected rights.** Nothing prevents a protected disclosure, reporting crime or harassment to the police or regulators, speaking to a lawyer, or communicating with a trade union.
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Part 9 – Performance, Discipline and Separation

9.1 Performance and Capability

- SIM-HR-001 2.1 applies. Capability concerns are raised informally first; if they continue, the Company follows a **formal capability procedure**: written invitation to a meeting with right to be accompanied; clear objectives, support and training; a review period of **60 to 90 days**; a written outcome with right of appeal.
- Capability issues arising from **ill health** are handled under 5.3, with medical advice and reasonable adjustments before any decision.

9.2 Disciplinary Procedure

The Company follows the **ACAS Code of Practice** from the first day of employment.

Step	Detail
1. Investigate	A proportionate and impartial investigation by someone not later involved in the decision; no pre-judgment
2. Written notice	The employee receives written notice of the allegations, the evidence and a hearing date, normally at least 3 working days ahead, and is told of the right to be accompanied by a colleague or trade union representative
3. Hearing	The employee can respond and present evidence and witnesses
4. Decision	In writing, normally within 5 working days , with reasons and the right of appeal
5. Sanctions	Written warning (valid typically 12 months), final written warning (typically 12–24 months), demotion or dismissal; dismissal without notice for gross misconduct
6. Appeal	To a more senior manager not previously involved, within 5 working days of the decision; heard promptly

- **Suspension** is a neutral act, on full pay, as short as possible and reviewed regularly.
- **Gross misconduct** examples: theft or fraud, serious breach of confidentiality or security, violence, serious harassment, serious breach of safety, bribery. The Company still follows a fair process.
- HR and employment counsel review every final warning and dismissal.

9.3 Resignation

- **Notice: 1 month** during the first 2 years of employment after probation, **2 months** from the third year, and **3 months** for senior roles as the contract states (the statutory minimum is 1 week after one month's service).
- The Company may waive notice, pay in lieu where the contract allows, or place the employee on garden leave with full pay.
- A handover plan is agreed (SIM-HR-001 9.1). Annual leave may be taken or paid in lieu.

9.4 Termination by the Company and Redundancy

Notice. At least the statutory minimum: **1 week for each complete year of service up to 12 weeks**, or the longer contractual period in 9.3. Pay in lieu is made only where the contract allows.

Unfair dismissal. Employees may claim unfair dismissal if dismissed without a **fair reason** (capability, conduct, redundancy, legal restriction, or some other substantial reason) or without a **fair procedure**. The qualifying service is currently **2 years**; under the Employment Rights Act 2025 it is scheduled to fall to **6 months** from January 1, 2027. There is no qualifying period for **automatically unfair** dismissals (for example, for pregnancy or family leave, whistleblowing, asserting a statutory right, health and safety activity, trade union membership) or for **discrimination**. The Company applies a fair process to every employee from day one regardless of service.

Time limits. A claim to the Employment Tribunal must be presented after **ACAS early conciliation**, within **3 months less one day** of the dismissal (the Act extends this to 6 months from a scheduled date; HR confirms the limit in force). The letter of dismissal states the right of appeal.

Redundancy.

1. **Genuine redundancy** means the requirement for work of a particular kind has ceased or diminished. HR and counsel review the business case, the pool, the selection criteria and alternatives.
2. **Consultation.** Individual consultation with at least **two meetings** and a right to be accompanied. If **20 or more** redundancies are proposed at one establishment within 90 days, **collective consultation** applies: at least **30 days** before the first dismissal (20–99 employees) or **45 days** (100 or more), with notification to the Secretary of State (form HR1) and election of employee representatives. Where the reforms in the Employment Rights Act 2025 on collective consultation commence, the Company follows them.
3. **Selection** uses objective, non-discriminatory criteria. Employees on or recently back from family leave get **priority for redeployment** (5.4).
4. **Notice and pay.** Statutory notice, plus **statutory redundancy pay** (after 2 years' service): for each full year of service, half a week's pay if under 22, one week's pay for

ages 22 to 40, and one and a half weeks' pay for age 41 and over, capped by the weekly pay limit and 20 years set each April. Simtora pays enhanced redundancy pay of **2 weeks' basic pay per full year of service (up to 15 years), minimum 4 weeks**, with no weekly pay cap, subject to a settlement agreement.

5. **Time off to look for work:** reasonable paid time off.

6. **Appeal** to a more senior manager.

Settlement agreements. The Company may offer a settlement agreement (for example, on redundancy or termination by mutual agreement). The employee must receive **independent legal advice**, for which the Company contributes up to GBP 1,000. "Without prejudice" discussions are held within the legal framework.

Special cases. HR and counsel check protection for employees who are pregnant, on family leave, disabled, or have made a protected disclosure, and that no discriminatory factors affect the decision. Fire-and-rehire to impose new terms is used only as a last resort after consultation and legal advice.

9.5 Final Pay and Offboarding

Item	Rule
Final pay	Salary to the last day, accrued untaken leave, notice pay where applicable, and bonus earned under the plan, in the next payroll or on the last working day if the departure is involuntary
Documents	P45 , written statement of service and pension information; statutory redundancy calculation where relevant
Property	Returned on or before the last day; no wage withholding to force a return
Access	IT removes access at or before the end (SIM-IT-001 3.3)
Reference	Through HR only: factual reference confirming dates and job title, and more with the former employee's consent (SIM-HR-001 9.5); references are accurate and fair
Exit interview	

Part 10 – Local Practices

10.1 Working with London and U.S. Teams

London is 8 hours ahead of San Francisco (7 hours for a few weeks around daylight-saving changes). The best shared window is **8:00–10:00 a.m. Pacific = 4:00–6:00 p.m. London**. London staff are not required to attend meetings after **7:00 p.m.** except in a declared incident or by rotation. London sits one hour from Berlin and Paris, giving easy overlap with those centers, and has good overlap with Lahore in the afternoon (SIM-HR-002 1.6).

10.2 Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland

The Company's UK employees are currently in England. If an employee works in Scotland, Wales or Northern Ireland, HR applies local variations (for example, different bank holidays in Scotland and Northern Ireland, different tribunals and, in Northern Ireland, separate employment legislation).

10.3 London Specifics

- **London weighting:** pay bands reflect the London labor market (SIM-HR-002 1.7).
 - **Commuting:** season-ticket loan and Cycle to Work (4.4); commuting costs are not otherwise reimbursed.
 - **Transport disruption:** remote work is available on request on strike days or severe disruption (SIM-FAC-001).
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Appendices

Appendix A – Key Terms Summary and Acknowledgement

Item	Summary
Employer	Simtora Technologies UK Limited
Hours	40 per week, Mon–Fri; core 10:00–15:00; 48-hour average cap
Probation	3 months (extendable to 6); 1 week's notice
Notice after probation	1 month (under 2 years), 2 months (2+ years), 3 months (senior roles)
Annual leave	25 days (rising to 28) + 8 bank holidays
Company sick pay	Full pay up to 20 days a year, then SSP
Parental	Statutory leave and pay; Simtora tops up to 12 weeks / 6 weeks at 100%
Pension	Employer 6%, employee minimum 4%
Life assurance	4 × basic salary
Unfair dismissal	2 years (6 months from Jan 1, 2027); fair process from day one

Acknowledgement. I have received this United Kingdom HR Manual (version __) and my written statement of employment particulars on or before my first day. I understand how the Company monitors systems (8.2), and that nothing in this manual limits my statutory rights, my right to be accompanied, or my right to make a protected disclosure.

Employee name (print)	
Signature	
Date	
Employee ID / Role	

Appendix B – Bank Holiday Calendar Rules

Holiday	Date
New Year's Day	January 1 (next working day if on a weekend)
Good Friday	Moves
Easter Monday	Moves
Early May bank holiday	First Monday in May
Spring bank holiday	Last Monday in May
Summer bank holiday	Last Monday in August
Christmas Day	December 25 (substitute if weekend)
Boxing Day	December 26 (substitute if weekend)

HR publishes the calendar by **December 1** and adds any one-off bank holidays proclaimed by the Government.

Appendix C – Statutory Deadlines

Item	Deadline
Written statement of particulars	On or before the first day
Self-certification of sickness	Up to 7 calendar days; fit note from day 8
Flexible working request decision	Within 2 months (Company: 1 month)
Maternity notice	By the 15th week before the expected week of childbirth
Unpaid parental leave notice	21 days
Subject access request	1 month (extendable by 2 months)
Collective consultation (20–99 / 100+)	30 days / 45 days
ACAS early conciliation / tribunal claim	Before the claim; 3 months less one day (confirm current limit)
P60 / P11D	May 31 / July 6
Records retention	6 years (personnel and payroll)

Appendix D – Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change	Approved by
1.0	October 5, 2026	HR	Initial release	CEO (October 5, 2026)

End of document – SIM-HR-105